

Urgent Maternal Warning Signs

You know your body best. If you experience something that seems unusual or is worrying you, don't ignore it.

DURING PREGNANCY

If you are pregnant, it's important to pay attention to your body and talk to your healthcare provider about anything that doesn't feel right. If you experience any of the urgent maternal warning signs, get medical care immediately.

AFTER PREGNANCY

While your new baby needs a lot of attention and care, it's important to remain aware of your own body and take care of yourself too. It's normal to feel tired and have some pain, particularly in the first few weeks after having a baby, but there are some symptoms that could be signs of more serious problems.

URGENT MATERNAL WARNING SIGNS

If you experience any of these warning signs, get medical care immediately:

- Severe headache that won't go away or gets worse over time
- Dizziness or fainting
- Thoughts about harming yourself or your baby
- Changes in your vision
- Fever of 100.4 F or higher
- Extreme swelling of your hands or face
- Trouble breathing
- Chest pain or fast-beating heart
- Severe nausea and throwing up (not like morning sickness)
- Severe belly pain that doesn't go away
- Baby's movement stopping or slowing down during pregnancy
- Vaginal bleeding or fluid leaking during pregnancy
- Heavy vaginal bleeding or leaking fluid that smells bad after pregnancy
- Swelling, redness, or pain of your leg

- Overwhelming tiredness

This list is not meant to cover every symptom you might have. If you feel like something just isn't right, talk to your healthcare provider.

TIPS FOR TALKING TO YOUR PROVIDER

- Bring a list of your symptoms and any questions you want to ask.
- Be sure to tell them you are pregnant or have been pregnant within the last year.
- Tell the doctor or nurse what medication you are currently taking or have recently taken.
- Take notes and ask more questions about anything you didn't understand.

Source: Adapted from the CDC Hear Her Campaign (U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention), a public domain U.S. government resource. Learn more at www.cdc.gov/HearHer.